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UNIT 4

CHAPTER 2

Trills and Thrills: Birdwatching in India

☀ **Salim Ali faced a threatening situation in one of his visits to Parambikulam for Birdwatching. He wrote a Diary that night. Write the likely diary for him.**

Diary Entry

February 14, 1946

9:45 pm

Wednesday

What an unforgettable day it was. From the first light of dawn, I was so excited to explore the grasslands with Baron Omar Rolf in search of the Broad-tailed Grass Warbler. The forest was alive, the trail narrow, and the grass towered over us. Events took an unexpected turn, Just as we turned a bend, the forest guard ducked and pointed—a tusker was heading straight toward us. I didn't know what to do. Life paused for a second. I motioned to Omar to run, and he flew like the wind, faster than I could believe. Amidst the chaos, I ran too, heart pounding, breath short. Exhausted... shocked... worn out... I still hear the rustle of grass and the pounding of feet. To be honest, I can't express my emotions. The elephant veered off, never saw us, but the moment will stay with me forever.

☀ **You have gained insights into Sálím Ali's life and achievements from his writing. Using the details given below, prepare his biographical sketch.**

Title :

Early life: Born in 1896 – developed interest in birds – became a naturalist and ornithologist

Major events : Conducted bird surveys across India – travelled through forests and mountains – faced thrilling and risky situations during fieldwork

Major accomplishments : First Indian to conduct systematic bird studies – wrote several books – co-authored ten-volume Handbook of the Birds of India and Pakistan with Sidney Dillon Ripley – received Padma Bhushan in 1958 and Padma Vibhushan in 1976

Interesting facts : Several species named after him – Salim Ali's Fruit Bat and Dwarf Gecko – bird sanctuaries and institutions also bear his name – watched birds for over fifty years for joy and learning

Biographical sketch of Salim Ali

The Birdman of India

Salim Ali was a renowned Indian ornithologist and naturalist, widely known as the Birdman of India. He was born in 1896 and developed a deep interest in birds from a young age. His passion led him to study bird life closely and become one of the most respected figures in Indian wildlife research.

He conducted bird surveys across India, travelling through forests, mountains, and remote regions. His fieldwork often involved thrilling and risky experiences, including encounters with wild animals and dangerous terrain. Despite these challenges, he continued his research with great dedication and curiosity.

Salim Ali was the first Indian to carry out systematic bird studies. He wrote several books on ornithology and co-authored the ten-volume Handbook of the Birds of India and Pakistan with Sidney Dillon Ripley. His contributions to science were recognised with the Padma Bhushan in 1958 and the Padma Vibhushan in 1976.

Many species have been named after him, such as Salim Ali's Fruit Bat and Salim Ali's Dwarf Gecko. Several bird sanctuaries and institutions also bear his name. He watched birds for over fifty years, His life remains a symbol of dedication to nature and the peaceful pursuit of knowledge.

☀️ You are planning to visit parambikulam for Birdwatching. You want to send an email to the forest officer seeking permission to explore the woods. Write the likely email

From: ramesh@gmail.com

To : forestofficerenklm@gmail.com

Date: 25 November 2025

Subject: Request for permission to visit Parambikulam for birdwatching

Respected Sir,

I am writing to request your kind permission to visit Parambikulam for birdwatching. I am a nature enthusiast and have a deep interest in observing birds in their natural habitat. I plan to visit the reserve on 25th December 2025 and would like to explore the forest trails with the help of a guide if available. I assure you that I will follow all rules and respect the environment during my visit. Kindly grant me permission and let me know the procedure to follow. I look forward to your positive response.

Thank you

Yours sincerely

Ramesh

Mob: 9847166798

☀️ Birdwatching is challenging and adventurous. You are asked to make a speech based on the chapter Trills and thrills: Birdwatching in India. Write the script for the speech

Good morning respected teachers and dear friends,

Today I am going to speak about the exciting and peaceful world of birdwatching. Birdwatching is may sound like a quiet hobby, but it is full of

surprises, discoveries, and sometimes even danger. Salim Ali, known as the Birdman of India, spent his life studying birds and exploring forests and mountains. He believed that birdwatching brings joy and peace, and also teaches us patience and love for nature.

In the chapter, Salim Ali shares his thrilling experiences from the forests of South India and the Himalayan trails. He once had a close encounter with a wild elephant in Parambikulam and another time nearly slipped off a cliff while watching a tiny bird. These stories show that birdwatching is not just about looking at birds but also about being brave, alert, and respectful of nature. He also talks about how birds behave in ways that surprise even experts, proving that nature is full of mysteries.

To conclude, birdwatching is a hobby that connects us with the beauty of the natural world. It teaches us to observe, to care, and to enjoy the little wonders around us. Salim Ali's life and adventures inspire us to explore nature with open eyes and a curious heart. Let us all take a moment to listen to the birds and learn from them. Thank you.

Article

Write an article on the topic 'Birdwatching as a peaceful adventure in Nature'

Birdwatching: A Peaceful Adventure with Hidden Thrills **Special Correspondent**

Birdwatching is often seen as a calm and quiet activity, perfect for those who love nature and enjoy observing birds in their natural surroundings. In India, with its rich variety of bird species, this hobby has grown in popularity and continues to attract both professionals and amateurs.

Though birdwatching is peaceful, it is not without moments of excitement. Salim Ali, known as the Birdman of India, spent decades exploring forests, mountains, and rivers to study birds. His experiences show that birdwatching can include unexpected thrills. He once escaped a wild elephant in the jungles of South India and nearly fell off a cliff while

tracking a tiny bird in the Himalayas. These incidents reveal that while the goal is peaceful observation, the journey can be full of surprises.

Birdwatching is more than a hobby. It is a way to understand and respect nature. Salim Ali's life reminds us that even peaceful pursuits can be adventurous. With the right spirit and preparation, birdwatching becomes a rewarding experience that blends calm with thrill, learning with joy.

☀ Interview questions you could ask Sálim Ali based on Trills and Thrills: Birdwatching in India

Interview questions

1. What first inspired your deep interest in birds and ornithology during your early years?
2. You have described birdwatching as both peaceful and thrilling—can you share what keeps you passionate about it after so many years?
3. In your experience, how do birds surprise us by behaving differently from what textbooks describe?
4. You have had close encounters with wild animals like elephants—how do you balance the risks of fieldwork with your love for birdwatching?
5. How do you feel about the changes in natural habitats, like the loss of Parambikulam to the hydro-electric project?
6. What advice would you give to young birdwatchers and nature lovers who want to follow your footsteps?

☀ Interview Questions (Simple)

1. Who inspired you greatly in your career
2. What are your strengths and weaknesses?
3. Share an inspiring incident from your life ?
4. What are your future goals?
5. Why do you love this career ?
6. What is your advice to the youngsters in this career

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